



YOU ARE **9 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
216 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

At about nine weeks, the human embryo measures about 1.2 in (3 cm). Most of the primitive organ systems are formed: the arms and legs have budded; the retina of the eye, and the nose, can be seen. The large dark mass is the enlarged liver.

“Your baby’s welfare will be your main concern, but rest assured that, however you’re feeling, she’ll be getting sustenance.”

You may be conscious of your health and well-being, but even if you’ve felt unwell, your baby has been taking what she needs from you: you have internal reserves of various minerals and substances, such as iron, and will still be absorbing some nutrients from what you eat. If you are eating a balanced diet, you will be getting most of the minerals and vitamins you and your baby need. You should also be taking 400 mcg of folic acid and 600–800 IU of vitamin D daily. You can take these as separate supplements or as a multivitamin. The latter should be one designed for pregnancy to ensure it does not contain harmful substances such as animal-derived vitamin A.

There is no cause for concern if you do not put on any weight in the first trimester, or even if you lose a bit of weight. The majority of weight gain takes place in the second and third trimesters (see [How much weight will you gain?](#)).

If you’re vomiting a lot and struggling to keep food down (see [You are 8 weeks and 3 days](#)), don’t hesitate to see your ob/gyn.

COUVADE SYNDROME

Can your partner ever really understand what you’re going through? According to a recent study, some dads don’t need a fake pregnancy belly to empathize. Known as Couvade syndrome, symptoms experienced by expectant fathers ranged from morning sickness to backaches, mood swings, and food cravings. Although, interestingly, often it was the woman claiming her partner had these symptoms.

Couvade is thought to happen because men are so deeply involved in the pregnancy. While others believe it could be jealousy (you’re getting all the attention) or guilt that he’s responsible for your condition and therefore your symptoms.

YOUR CHANGING BREASTS

Breast changes are caused by both an increased blood supply and a rise in pregnancy hormones, particularly in the first 12 weeks.